

SOP-LV-033 — WHMIS 2015 & Hazard Communication

Identifying, Handling, and Storing Controlled Products Safely

SOP NUMBER	SOP-LV-033
TITLE	WHMIS 2015 & Hazard Communication
EFFECTIVE DATE	July 25, 2026
REVISION	1.0
APPLIES TO	All Apex field technicians — Ontario & Manitoba
CATEGORY	Hazard Communication (WHMIS)

1. Purpose

This procedure ensures Apex technicians can identify, handle, store, and respond to exposure from hazardous products used in the course of work — firestop sealant, contact cleaner, adhesives, and batteries — in accordance with WHMIS 2015.

2. Scope

This SOP applies to all Apex technicians who use, store, or transport controlled products as part of their work.

3. Definitions

- WHMIS — Workplace Hazardous Materials Information System, Canada's hazard communication standard, aligned with the Globally Harmonized System (GHS).
- Safety Data Sheet (SDS) — the standardized document giving detailed hazard, handling, and emergency information for a controlled product.
- Pictogram — the standardized hazard symbols found on a supplier label.
- Supplier Label vs. Workplace Label — the original label from the manufacturer, versus a label required when a product is transferred to a different container at the worksite.

4. Training Requirement

Every Apex technician completes WHMIS 2015 training before using any controlled product, and refreshes it whenever a new product or hazard class is introduced to their work, per Apex policy.

5. Reading a Label

- Product identifier — what the product is.
- Pictograms — quick visual indicators of the hazard class.
- Signal word — “Danger” (more severe) or “Warning” (less severe).
- Hazard statements and precautionary statements.
- Supplier information.

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6. Safety Data Sheets

Review the SDS before first using any new product. Current SDS documents are kept in the Apex SDS reference — confirm with your supervisor where to access them for the products you carry. An SDS more than three years old should be treated as out of date; flag it to your supervisor for an update.

7. Workplace Labels

If a product is transferred out of its original container, the new container must be labelled with the product identifier and basic hazard information — unless it will be used immediately, by the same person, within the same shift.

8. Common Products Apex Technicians Use

- Firestop sealant / caulking — skin and eye irritant; ventilate the work area.
- Contact cleaner / compressed air duster — flammable; never use near an open flame or energized equipment.
- Adhesives — skin contact and inhalation hazards; ventilate and avoid prolonged skin contact.
- Batteries (UPS, access control) — electrolyte and short-circuit hazard; handle per SDS and manufacturer guidance.

9. Safe Storage and Transport in the Van

- Segregate incompatible materials — check SDS compatibility notes if unsure.
- Keep containers closed and secured so they cannot tip or leak in transit.
- Keep SDS access information with you or know how to retrieve it quickly.
- Ventilate the van when transporting products with strong fumes.

10. Spill and Exposure Response

- Eye contact: flush with water for at least 15 minutes and seek medical attention.
- Skin contact: wash thoroughly with soap and water.
- Inhalation: move to fresh air immediately.
- For anything beyond a minor exposure, follow the specific guidance in that product's SDS and report the incident immediately.

11. Prohibited Practices

- Never use the contents of an unlabelled container.
- Never mix cleaning products or chemicals.
- Never store incompatible materials together in the van.

12. Regulatory References

- Hazardous Products Act (Canada) and Hazardous Products Regulations — WHMIS 2015

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- Ontario Occupational Health and Safety Act, s. 42, and R.R.O. 1990, Regulation 860 (WHMIS)
- Manitoba Workplace Safety and Health Act, C.C.S.M. c. W210, and its WHMIS-related regulations

13. Related Apex Documents

- SOP-LV-004 — Power Tools Safety
- SOP-LV-HSK-001 — Jobsite Housekeeping

14. Revision History

Rev.	Date	Description	Approved By
1.0	Jul 25, 2026	Initial release	P. Cimini

This document is proprietary to Apex and is intended for internal use by Apex technicians and supervisors. Effective date: July 25, 2026.